



The Bucket Approach

Money you'll need soon stays safe and liquid. Money you won't need for years stays invested to grow.

BUCKET 1

Years 1–5

Short-Term Income

Holds 3–5 years of planned withdrawals in safe, liquid assets — so you're never forced to sell investments in a down market.

Money Market Spending cash · always available

Covers near-term withdrawals

Treasury Ladder One rung matures each year to fund income

Year 1 Treasury	
Year 2 Treasury	
Year 3 Treasury	
Year 4 Treasury	
Year 5 Treasury	

TODAY MATURITY →

BUCKET 2

Beyond Year 5

Long-Term Growth

Money you won't touch for at least five years stays invested in a diversified mix — with time to grow and recover from market dips.

Stocks

Bonds

Your mix is set to your plan

YOU

MORE CONSERVATIVE MORE GROWTH

Where you land depends on your goals, timeline and comfort with risk.

1 Spend

The money market and this year's maturing Treasury fund your income.

2 Refill

Growth-bucket gains buy a new Treasury at the end of the ladder.

3 Stay the course

In a down market, pause refills and live off the ladder while stocks recover.

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Hypothetical illustration for educational purposes only.

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